Spikes!

70

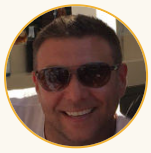
BDT 2002 · Marbella · Featuring Hursty

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

This one is a tour tail courtesy of the Monkey, entitled: "Changing Spikes". It comes from BDT 2002 and is yet another “sweating” incident from that Inaugural Tour. Over to James.



Atalaya – Zero Recollection!



HURSTY

“Well, having racked my brain through all the memoirs of tours gone by I had to settle on a tour tail which has to go down as one of the lowlights of my Big Dogs Tour Career to date.

The incident occurred on the penultimate day of the Inaugural Tour following what can only be described as a week-long drinking session with a couple of token rounds of golf chucked in for good measure!

Ravo had recommended the choice of course for our second round having been out there with work a few weeks earlier and had kindly given us some cheeky discount vouchers providing us with half price golf with some buggies. I bet not many of even the Inaugurals can remember the course; well, it was called Atalaya.

Anyway, having got in from Puerto Banus some four hours earlier we embarked upon our journey to the course some 20 minutes away during which I began to feel some demons entering the car who started trying to get into my head. This immediately made me slightly nauseous and it was a welcome relief when we arrived at our destination.

As I was responsible for organising the golf, I entered the pro shop to sign us all in and all was sweet until the Señor proclaimed that we were only allowed the buggies for nine holes. As it was 98 degrees and we had a week's beer sweats to contend with, this was far from ideal.

'No problemo' I said to the Spaniard, we will return them after 9 and walk the rest (turning round to BT and whispering under my breath... 'whatever!').



Atalaya Clubhouse – the Scene of the Sweats!

Worse, however, was soon to follow. As this was many years ago, rubber spikes were not the norm and I happened to be the only dog wearing the old spikes. So as I was clickety clicking away down the footpath, Señor called me back. 'No spikes on the golf course,' he said!! 'B*llocks', I said!

My options were twofold; I either bought a new pair of golf shoes (which having already spunked my month's salary wasn't ideal) or I set about taking my spikes out of my golf shoes with the stud screw lent to me by my new best enemy. I chose the latter which to this day I regret!

It soon became very obvious that my spikes weren't going to come out with ease and whichever bloke screwed them in did a damn good job of it. After 20 minutes and having finally managed to get through my first shoe I thought I was going to faint as sweat poured off every part of my body.

There and then I very nearly retired to the bar and let the guys get on with the round but no I battled on using every last bit of energy I could muster to get the second shoe done. Finally after possibly the worst half an hour of my life I released the last spike and was ready for the first tee, except that I was seeing stars and feeling incredibly sick! Thankfully I had a buggy!

Teeing off with my fellow dogs in the last group, the last place I really felt like being was on the first tee of a golf course in 98 degrees wearing golf shoes which felt like my work shoes!! Needless to say, teeing off down possibly the narrowest fairway ever, I sliced the ball right into the s.hit, nearly slipped on my ass and proceeded to have a 'mare!!

After 15 less than memorable holes, out of the distance came a rather angry looking Señor shouting and screaming expletives about us taking the buggies back after 9!! With little argument from me he red carded us all and promptly threw us off the course. What a relief!

I have to say, it was a tour experience I will never forget!"



An exhausted Monkey!